

Who's making you say this?

ElevenLabs · Instagram Reel · 9:16 · 0:54 · one actor (suspect + detective)

A detective plays a terrified, chained suspect his own recorded threat and makes him repeat it. When the detective loses his temper, the bulb starts to flicker and the suspect cracks: every time the light comes on he's a different man in a different language. Then a sobbing tape, and the suspect cries along with it word for word without being asked. When the detective finally asks who gave him the words, the answer is "You did." The detective leans into the light. Same face. His case file holds the whole performance, written line by line with emotion tags.

Cast (one actor)

- **ARJUN, the detective.** Dark navy shirt, sleeves rolled, steel watch. Face hidden until 0:37.5. Patient, almost bored: he has heard these takes before. He raises his voice exactly twice, both in the flicker, and both times it's a direction, not a loss of temper.
- **THE SUSPECT.** Arjun's voice given a body. Same face. Crumpled white shirt, top button open, sweat at the hairline, hair a little messier. Handcuffed, with the chain run through a steel ring on the table. He starts as the most frightened man in the room and ends as the calmest.

Set and look

- **Room:** interrogation room, darkness beyond the walls. Steel table with a welded steel ring, two chairs, one low hanging bulb with a shade between them. The shade is what keeps the detective's face out of the light.
- **On the table:** a blue Sony Walkman (no headphones), an evidence bag holding two cassettes labelled EXHIBIT A and EXHIBIT B, and a closed manila folder stamped CASE NO. 11.
- **Palette:** cold, desaturated room with one warm pool of light. Only two things in the film are saturated: the blue Walkman and the purple tags on the case file page.
- **Camera:** Exhibit A pushes in slowly. The flicker breaks every rule, with a new angle on every flash. After "ENOUGH!" the camera goes still and tight. The question and reveal open back up to a symmetrical frame with the bulb in the centre.

Pacing map

Section	Time	Length	What the viewer learns
Hook	0:00–0:06	6s	That voice doesn't belong to that face.
Exhibit A	0:06–0:15	9s	He can switch to the menacing voice on command.
The flicker	0:15–0:25.5	10.5s	Every time the light comes on, he's a different man in a different language.
Exhibit B	0:25.5–0:33	7.5s	He doesn't need to be asked anymore.
The question	0:33–0:37.5	4.5s	Everything slows down. Silence.
Reveal	0:37.5–0:46	8.5s	Same face. The file.
Button	0:46–0:49.5	3.5s	"You asked for one."
End card	0:49.5–0:53.5	4s	ElevenLabs.

The film builds to the flicker, its loudest and fastest moment. "ENOUGH!" kills it, and from there everything gets quieter and slower: a sobbing tape, a STOP click, one question, and the silence before "You did." That silence should be the loudest moment in the film.

Shooting script

HOOK (0:00–0:06)

1 · 0:00–0:01 · ECU, Walkman, top-down

A finger presses PLAY. *CLUNK*. The reels start turning. Tape hiss.

TAPE (*calm, menacing*): I know—

2 · 0:01–0:03 · CU, Suspect

Cut while the line is still playing. The voice on the tape is ice cold; the face under the bulb is shaking, eyes wet. His cuffed hands grip the table edge. He flinches at his own voice.

TAPE: —where you sleep.

3 · 0:03–0:04 · OTS from behind the detective

The detective's shoulder and the back of his head, black against the dark; the suspect beyond him, lit.

DETECTIVE: You said this?

4 · 0:04–0:06 · CU, Suspect

SUSPECT (*scared*): Sir, please... (*gulps*) I didn't have a choice.

EXHIBIT A (0:06–0:15)

5 · 0:06–0:08 · Insert, detective's hands

His hands rest flat on the closed case file, in the light. His face stays above it, in shadow.

DETECTIVE: Say it. Exactly like the tape.

6 · 0:08–0:10 · MCU, Suspect

SUSPECT (*nervous, stammering*): I... I know where you... sleep.

7 · 0:10–0:12 · Insert, detective's hand

One finger taps the table once.

DETECTIVE: No. (*beat*) The way you said it.

8 · 0:12–0:15 · Slow push-in, Suspect

He lowers his eyes. The shaking stops. He looks up. Dead calm, identical to the tape:

SUSPECT (*calm, menacing*): I know where you sleep.

Sound: room tone drops out under the line.

THE FLICKER (0:15–0:25.5)

9 · 0:15–0:17 · CU, detective's fist, rising into a medium OTS (one shot)

The fist slams the table. *BANG*. The Walkman jumps, the chain rattles, the bulb swings and flickers. Without cutting, the camera rises over the detective's shoulder to a medium shot of the suspect.

DETECTIVE (*shouting*): You think this is a game?! WHO ARE YOU?!

10 · 0:17–0:18 · OTS, quick push-in on the Suspect

He flinches hard. His breath catches. Something switches behind his eyes; his focus goes somewhere far away.

Sound: a thin, high whine rises, like ringing ears. It keeps building through the whole flicker.

11 · 0:18–0:23.5 · The strobe

The bulb dies and stutters back to life, faster each time. Every flash is a new angle and a different man. Black between flashes, and the dark cuts every voice off mid-breath.

- **Flash 1 · 0:18 · Low angle, CU.** Tears, hands pressed together as far as the cuffs allow, begging.

SUSPECT (*terrified, begging*): ¡Por favor, yo no fui!
 Subtitle: *Please, it wasn't me!*

- **Flash 2 · 0:19.4 · Dutch angle, MCU.** On his feet, yanked short by the chain, furious, shouting into the dark.

SUSPECT (*shouting*): तू जानता नहीं मैं कौन हूँ!
 Subtitle: *You don't know who I am!*

- **Flash 3 · 0:21 · Top-down.** Both fists hammering the table, the chain snapping taut against the steel ring again and again.

SUSPECT (*screams*)

- **Flash 4 · 0:21.9 · ECU, eyes and mouth.** Perfectly still. He leans into the light and laughs, slow and menacing.

SUSPECT (*laughs menacingly*): Я знаю, где ты спишь.
 Subtitle: *I know where you sleep.*

- **0:23 · The stutter.** The bulb buzzes and stutters dim-to-bright. All four voices overlap: begging, shouting, screaming, laughing. The whine peaks.

12 · 0:23.5–0:24 · OTS, the detective half-risen, a black silhouette looming into frame

DETECTIVE (*roaring*): ENOUGH!

The bulb slams on and stays on. Every sound cuts dead.

13 · 0:24–0:25.5 · CU, Suspect

He's frozen mid-scream. His mouth snaps shut. Tears, shaking breath, the chain still taut in his fists. Only the bulb's hum, settling.

EXHIBIT B (0:25.5–0:33)

14 · 0:25.5–0:26.5 · Insert, Walkman

Calm again, as if nothing happened, the detective ejects the cassette and slides in EXHIBIT B. *CLACK. CLUNK.*

15 · 0:26.5–0:30.5 · CU, Suspect

The tape starts sobbing. By the second "please", the suspect's lips are already moving with it. His eyes fill. He joins in perfect unison, real tears falling. Nobody asked him to this time.

TAPE (*crying*): Please...

TAPE + SUSPECT (*crying, in unison*): ...please, I'm begging you. (*sobs*) Just let me go home.

Sound: the two voices merge into one. You can't tell them apart.

16 · 0:30.5–0:31 · Insert, Walkman

The detective's finger presses STOP. *CLICK.* Dead silence.

17 · 0:31–0:33 · CU, Suspect

He wipes his face with the back of his hand. Drained.

SUSPECT (*exhausted*): I only said what I was told.

THE QUESTION (0:33–0:37.5)

18 · 0:33–0:35.5 · Wide, symmetrical

The bulb in the centre. The suspect on the left, in the light. The detective on the right, in shadow. The detective leans forward; his face stops just short of the light.

DETECTIVE: Who gave you the words?

19 · 0:35.5–0:37.5 · CU, Suspect

He doesn't look away. He's steady now. A pause.

SUSPECT: ...You did.

Sound: bulb hum only.

REVEAL (0:37.5–0:46)

20 · 0:37.5–0:40.5 · MCU, Detective

He leans into the light. Same face. He isn't surprised. The smallest smile. He knew all along.

Sound: one low sub hit as the light lands on his face.

21 · 0:40.5–0:41.5 · Symmetrical two-shot

The same man on both sides of the bulb.

22 · 0:41.5–0:43 · Insert, table

He slides CASE NO. 11 into the light, opens it and turns it toward the suspect.

23 · 0:43–0:46 · Insert, case file page

The speaker chip: "Arjun - My Voice". Tilt down through everything we've heard (menacing, stammering, Spanish, Hindi, the scream, Russian, crying) and stop on "You did." The last line stays below frame.

Sound: paper, then a faint tape hiss returns underneath.

BUTTON (0:46–0:49.5)

24 · 0:46–0:48 · MCU, Detective

Quiet, almost proud.

DETECTIVE: You made me sound like a monster.

25 · 0:48–0:49.5 · CU, Suspect

For the first time, he's the calmest man in the room.

SUSPECT (*deadpan*): You asked for one.

HARD CUT TO BLACK on the last word.

END CARD (0:49.5–0:53.5)

26 · Black

Half a beat of silence. The ElevenLabs logo lands on the Walkman's *CLUNK*.

ElevenLabs. Your voice. Whatever the role.

Optional: the suspect's voice reads the line, warm and friendly. It's the first time we hear that voice sound kind, which makes it one last demo.

Every line, by character

SUSPECT (matches the case file page word for word)

1. (*calm, menacing*) I know where you sleep. (*on tape, then live*)
2. (*scared*) Sir, please... (*gulps*) I didn't have a choice.
3. (*nervous, stammering*) I... I know where you... sleep.

4. (*terrified, begging*) ¡Por favor, yo no fui! (*Spanish: "Please, it wasn't me!"*)
5. (*shouting*) तू जानता नहीं मैं कौन हूँ! (*Hindi: "You don't know who I am!"*)
6. (*screams*)
7. (*laughs menacingly*) Я знаю, где ты спишь. (*Russian: "I know where you sleep."*)
8. (*crying*) Please... please, I'm begging you. (*sobs*) Just let me go home. (*tape, then in unison*)
9. (*exhausted*) I only said what I was told.
10. ...You did.
11. (*deadpan*) You asked for one.

DETECTIVE

1. You said this?
2. Say it. Exactly like the tape.
3. No. (*beat*) The way you said it.
4. You think this is a game?! WHO ARE YOU?!
5. ENOUGH!
6. Who gave you the words?
7. You made me sound like a monster.

After "ENOUGH!" the detective never raises his voice again. By Exhibit B he doesn't need to direct at all.

Performance notes

- **Suspect: his status climbs the whole film**, with one dip: "ENOUGH!" knocks him to the floor right before the final climb. Every switch has to be instant. Don't ease into an emotion: the snap from one voice to the next is the product demo, and the snap is the wow.
- **The flicker: each flash is a complete, committed man, not a mood swing.** Fear, rage, a scream, a calm laugh. Hit each one at full intensity from the first frame and let the dark do the editing.
- **Detective: flat and patient, except for two shouts.** He's never surprised, not even at "You did." His smile at the reveal is pride, not menace.
- **His lines are really direction notes.** "Exactly like the tape", "The way you said it", even "WHO ARE YOU?!" should play as an interrogation the first time and as directing on a rewatch.

Rewatch clues

- **A small scar across the left knuckle on both characters.** It's on the finger that presses PLAY at 0:00 and on the suspect's hand when he wipes his tears at 0:31.
- **The light obeys the detective.** It starts flickering when he slams the table and snaps back on when he shouts "ENOUGH!"
- **The Russian flash is the opening threat again**, in another language.

- **The suspect knows the second tape's words before he hears them.** He's already mouthing along by the second "please".

Sound

- No score. Room tone, the bulb's hum, tape hiss, the chain, and the Walkman's mechanics (PLAY clunk, eject clack, STOP click) are the rhythm section.
- The flicker: a hard low hit on the fist, an electrical crackle on every flash, and dead silence in every dark gap, with each voice cut off clean. The whine builds under all of it, peaks in the stutter, and dies on "ENOUGH!"
- Tape voice: slightly band-limited, with hiss and a little wow and flutter. The live repeat is clean and close. The performances are identical; only the source differs.
- One sub hit at the reveal (0:37.5). After "ENOUGH!", nothing else is that loud.
- Master to -14 LUFS, true peak at or below -1 dBTP.

Captions

- Burn in every line. Many people watch Reels muted, and the hook has to land on frame one without sound.
- Tape lines in italics, live lines in roman, so viewers can tell which voice is coming from the Walkman.
- Spanish, Hindi and Russian: the original line small on top, the English subtitle below. Each caption appears and disappears with its flash.

Case file insert

Printed page clipped inside the folder, styled like the voice editor: speaker chip, then each line with its emotion tags. Source and print-ready files: [props/case-file-page.html](#) , [props/case-file-page.pdf](#) (A4), [props/case-file-page.png](#) (preview).

(● Arjun - My Voice)

[calm] [menacing] I know where you sleep.

[scared] Sir, please... [gulps] I didn't have a choice.

[nervous] [stammering] I... I know where you... sleep.

[terrified] [begging] ¡Por favor, yo no fui!

[shouting] तू जानता नहीं मैं कौन हूँ!

[screams]

[laughs menacingly] Я знаю, где ты спишь.

[crying] Please... please, I'm begging you. [sobs] Just let me go home.

[exhausted] I only said what I was told.

[short pause] You did.

[deadpan] You asked for one.

———— + Add speaker ————

- "Arjun" is a placeholder: use the actor's or character's name. "My Voice" on the chip is what makes the connection click instantly.
- The same line appears twice with different tags ([menacing] vs [nervous] [stammering]). That's the payoff of "The way you said it."
- The flicker's four lines sit one after another on the page: what looked like a breakdown was four takes.
- Frame the insert so it ends on "You did." The last line, "You asked for one.", stays below frame so it isn't read before it's spoken. It's on the page for anyone who pauses on a rewatch.

Props

- **Walkman:** a blue and silver TPS-L2-style Sony Walkman, no headphones.
- **Cassettes:** two, in an evidence bag, stickered EXHIBIT A and EXHIBIT B. The swap gives a door *clack* that marks the beat change.
- **Cuffs and chain:** the chain runs through a steel ring welded to the table. It must be long enough for him to stand and hammer the table, and short enough to yank him back before he reaches the detective.
- **Bulb:** a practical bulb on a dimmer or DMX so the flicker happens in camera, timed to the sound.
- **Case file:** a manila folder stamped CASE NO. 11 (a nod to the brand). It sits closed on the table from Exhibit A, so opening it later feels set up.

Production notes

- **Strobe safety.** Keep full on/off flashes to three per second or fewer, and make the final stutter dim-to-bright rather than black-to-white. Faster, harsher strobes can trigger photosensitive seizures, and platforms can flag them.
- **Same actor, both roles.** The detective's face is never seen before 0:37.5, so a stand-in can play him in every over-the-shoulder, fist and silhouette shot. Shoot all the suspect coverage first, then the detective's. The two-shot at 0:40.5 is a locked-off split screen, with the bulb as the seam.
- **If the film is AI-generated,** use one locked character reference for both roles and tell them apart only by wardrobe and hair.
- **The original Walkman has no speaker.** Viewers won't question it. For an airtight version, run a short cable to a small speaker just out of frame.
- **SONY / WALKMAN lettering is a third-party trademark.** If this runs as an official ElevenLabs ad, cover it or angle it away from camera.